

space in which to install Linux. This is where you have to be careful: choosing the wrong partition could mean your existing data being wiped out, or your Windows installation not working.

Recall that we'd asked you to keep some space reserved for Linux. You will now proceed to install Linux in that free space / partition. Read the on-screen instructions *carefully*—in fact, very carefully.

Important: When prompted to choose the kind of install, choose “custom” and choose to “manually edit” the partitions.

If during the course of the setup, you will find the option to install a server, just say no! If you install Linux as a server, you will not have a GUI, meaning no mouse, no graphics. This is because a server needs far more resources than a client or stand-alone system. Hence, the overhead of running a GUI is done away with in the case of a server.

Also, when server mode is chosen for installation, in most cases, the entire hard disk is wiped clean—not something you would want if you're looking at multi-booting.

The next step would be to choose where Linux gets installed. When you choose a Manual Edit of the partition table, you will see the various partitions and their sizes. The partition type “*vfat*” refers to the Windows partition. Here, you will need to specify which partition Linux has to install to. But before that, you need to format the freed up space (which should appear as ‘Unallocated’ or ‘Free Space’) as an “*ext2*” or “*ext3*” type of partition. Click on Edit (or an equivalent command, just follow the on screen instructions, and format it as mentioned above. Next, make it a mount point for “/”.

Recall now that we'd asked you to make another partition of 500 MB. This is to set Linux to use it as a swap partition. For this you will have to format it as a swap. In the partition manager / editor, choose to make it a *swap* type. In the mounting options, choose *swap* again if available. If the *swap* option is not present, Linux will